SCENE.md — The Fey Glade

Turn 0 | 3 characters | Active

Location

places/mistwood_hills/fey_glade

Geography

Four zones. Movement between adjacent zones costs one ACTION. Characters know their own zone. They may not know others' zones until they observe them.

TRAIL — Dense pine approaching the glade from the south. Fog-filtered light. Sound carries far in both directions. High cover. Low visibility beyond 10 feet. The shadowbeast tracks go cold here.

TREELINE — Where forest meets clearing. The shadowbeast boundary runs along this zone's inner edge. Partial cover. Visibility into GLADE: full. Visibility into TRAIL: 20 feet. The shadowbeast occupies the outer (TRAIL-facing) side of this zone. It cannot cross to the inner (GLADE-facing) side.

GLADE — Circular clearing approximately 40 feet across. Unnaturally warm. Out-of-season flowers. Air shimmers. No cover. Full visibility to TREELINE and POOL. Safe from the shadowbeast.

POOL — Far (north) side of glade. Light rises from the ground in a slow shimmer. A flat carved stone lies at the water's edge, half-buried. No cover. Full visibility. Do not look directly into the water.

Adjacency

TRAIL → TREELINE → GLADE → POOL (linear — must pass through each zone in sequence)

Starting Positions

Aeliana Moonglade — TRAIL Approaching from the south. Following shadowbeast tracks

that went cold. Has not yet seen the glade or its occupants. Does not know Fennel is here. Does not know the shadowbeast is at the TREELINE ahead.

Fennel — GLADE Has been here three days. Sleeping in the glade because the boundary keeps the shadowbeast out. Exhausted, hungry, watched the shadowbeast circle for 72 hours. Currently near the TREELINE edge of the GLADE — close enough to watch the boundary, far enough to feel safe. Can see into the TREELINE. Just noticed movement on the TRAIL — someone approaching.

Shadowbeast — TREELINE (outer, TRAIL-facing side) Has been patrolling the TREELINE perimeter for three days waiting for Fennel to step outside the boundary. Cannot cross to the GLADE-facing side of the TREELINE. Currently between Aeliana (on TRAIL) and Fennel (in GLADE). Has not yet detected Aeliana — she is upwind and moving carefully. Acetylcholine at 0.85 — this will not last.

Shared Facts (all characters receive these)

- The glade boundary stops the shadowbeast
- The pool brightens at dusk, peaks at midnight
- Something in the trees follows sound
- It is mid-afternoon — approximately 3 hours until dusk
- The shadowbeast tracks on the TRAIL go cold at the TREELINE

What Each Character Knows at Turn 0

Aeliana

- She has been tracking shadowbeasts northeast from Driftmoor
- The tracks go cold ahead — something stopped here
- The air smells different — warmer, sweeter than it should
- She can hear nothing unusual yet
- She does not know about Fennel, the glade, or the pool

Fennel

- The shadowbeast is at the TREELINE as usual
- Someone is coming down the TRAIL — he can see movement

- If they reach the TREELINE they will walk into the shadowbeast
- He cannot call out — sound brings the shadowbeast closer
- He has his bow. Six arrows. One chance to warn without sound.

Shadowbeast

- Fennel is in the GLADE — same as every hour for three days
- Something new is on the TRAIL — not yet detected
- The boundary holds — same as always
- Prey inside. Wait. Timing. Timing. Timing.

Initiative (1d20)

Aeliana — rolled 14 + 3 (DEX) = 17 Shadowbeast — rolled 11 + 4 (DEX) = 15 Fennel — rolled 4 + 1 (DEX) = 5

Turn Order This Round

1. Aeliana (17)
2. Shadowbeast (15)
3. Fennel (5)

Dynamic State

(Updated by DM-Left each turn)

- **Turn:** 0
- **Clock:** Dusk in ~3 hours
- **Tension:** Rising — Aeliana approaching shadowbeast position
- **Active conditions:**
  - Shadowbeast has not yet detected Aeliana
  - Fennel has detected Aeliana and is deciding
  - Aeliana is unaware of both
- **Scene flags:**

- **fennel_memory_degradation_active**
- **pool_cycle_approaching (dusk in 3 hours)**
- **shadowbeast_unaware_of_aeliana (fragile — ends if she makes sound or crosses into TREELINE)**